EKATERINA DEYS

Head of Product | Fintech & Payments · hands-on, team builder

Armenia · Available from November 2026 · Remote · Open to relocation · katedeys@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/kate-deys · Portfolio: katedeys.github.io/katedeys-portfolio

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product leader with 10+ years in tech (7+ in product) in fintech and payments: consumer payment flows and balance top-ups, KYC and onboarding, card payments, lending and remittances across 40+ countries. Built and led product teams at Tinkoff and Sbermarket: hiring, growth plans, regular feedback and performance reviews. Hands-on by choice: discovery interviews, SQL and Amplitude/Mixpanel funnels, A/B tests and prototypes, plus AI automation in daily work (built my own AI agent on Claude that pulls jobs from ATS APIs, scores them and runs a Telegram bot). Ties product work to revenue and retention: a CPA model adopted by 90% of sellers, a paid subscription MVP, churn down 15%, transaction volume up 1.5%. English C1.

SELECTED IMPACT

- Designed and launched a CPA monetization model adopted by 90% of wholesale sellers at Drom.ru.
- Launched a paid analytics subscription MVP at Sbermarket (3 of 5 pilot retailers converted to paid) and reduced retailer churn by 15%.
- Built consumer payment flows at inDrive across 40+ countries: transaction volume up 1.5%, processing costs down ~$100K/month, 96.4% provider SLA.
- Ran the agent channel for internet acquiring at Tinkoff: revenue share plus first-activation bonus, agent cabinet and payouts; ~15% of new merchants came through agents.
- Took a remittance product from zero to MVP at SkyRo and pivoted it into cross-border repayments for families of borrowers.
- Led product teams at Tinkoff and Sbermarket (2 PMs + 1 project manager each, matrix) through the full cycle: hiring, 1:1s, growth plans, performance reviews and a mentoring programme.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Technical Product Manager — Payments Platform

Oct 2025 – Oct 2026

SkyRo · Malaysia (remote) · contract

- Owned product direction for the payments platform behind credit products (disbursements, repayments, wallet operations, partner integrations), used by lending and origination teams.
- Took a remittance product from zero to MVP to capture migrant remittances (Gulf → Southeast Asia) into our lending market, then pivoted it into cross-border repayments: relatives abroad top up a family member's credit line at home. Ran partner selection, designed money, data and system flows (AED/SAR → USD → local, reusable partner KYC ID, kinship check on our side), negotiated a margin-plus-interbank-FX model, and planned the move from remittance-as-a-service to an in-house build.
- Designed and piloted remittance history as an income signal in credit scoring, so recipients could qualify for loans in the local market.
- Was part of the discovery team for a refer-a-friend programme: researched reward mechanics on the market, designed the technical and legal scheme for referral rewards, and defined compliance checks (sanctions and AML screening of referred users).
- Designed asynchronous full-payoff calculation with invalidation and revalidation before execution, so customers are charged the exact amount owed at payment time.
- Designed asynchronous disbursement flows with callbacks, status checks, idempotency, retries and reconciliation to prevent duplicate or missed money movements, which removed manual payout investigations entirely.
- Launched multi-channel repayments in Malaysia with 2 partners and 3 methods each (cards via PSPs, bank transfers via Virtual IBANs, cash); 100% of bank-transfer repayments reconcile automatically through Virtual IBANs.

Technical Product Manager — Payments

Jan 2023 – Sep 2025

inDrive · Astana, Kazakhstan

- Built the payment orchestration platform end to end, from discovery and solution design through partner integrations, pilot and rollout, scaling from 4 to 40+ countries.

- Designed cost-aware routing based on provider priority, amount, limits, geographic coverage and processing cost, saving ~$100K/month (~20%).
- Designed failover logic using soft/hard decline classification, defining retry eligibility and alternative routing paths.
- Defined unified status and error mapping, aligning external provider responses with one internal transaction state model for consistent, auditable outcomes.
- Designed provider health management (backlogs, timeouts, alerts, support signals), automatic exclusion and gradual traffic restoration, reaching a 96.4% SLA.
- Led PCI DSS Service Provider certification, coordinating Product, Engineering, Security and Compliance.
- Optimized payment flows, growing transaction volume by 1.5%; managed PSP relationships across integrations, incidents and performance reviews.

Lead Product Manager May 2022 – Jan 2023
Tinkoff Bank · Russia

- Automated merchant onboarding, cutting it from 1 month to 2 weeks and reducing support volume by 23%.
- Owned the agent channel for internet acquiring: external aggregators resold it for a revenue share plus a fixed bonus on each merchant's first activation. Built the agent cabinet, onboarding, reward calculation and payouts, plus merchant onboarding through agents; 6 large and many smaller agents brought ~15% of new merchants, supported by agent training and first-month special terms for their merchants.
- Managed a team of 2 product managers and 1 project manager (matrix) through the full cycle: hiring (3 hires after 40+ interviews), onboarding, growth plans, 1:1 feedback and performance reviews; ran a junior-to-middle mentoring programme.
- Introduced an OKR-based discovery-to-delivery operating model for the team.

Lead / Senior Product Manager Jun 2020 – May 2022
Sbermarket · Russia

- Built financial reconciliation and reporting products for the top 40 retailers, cutting report preparation from 1 day to 1.5 hours.
- Launched a paid SMB analytics subscription MVP (3 of 5 pilot retailers converted to paid); reduced retailer churn by 15%.
- Managed a team of 2 product managers and 1 project manager (matrix) through the full cycle: hiring, onboarding, growth plans, 1:1 feedback and performance reviews.

Product Manager Jan 2019 – Jun 2020
Drom.ru · Russia

- Designed and launched a CPA monetization model adopted by 90% of wholesale sellers; reduced listing errors from 20% to 4% through automation.

Project Manager 2015 – 2018
Interfaced

SKILLS

Product & growth: discovery interviews · funnel analysis (e.g. KYC → first payment) · A/B testing · activation, retention and ARPPU · monetization (CPA, subscriptions) · prototyping

Leadership: building product teams · hiring · 1:1s and feedback · growth plans · performance reviews · OKRs

Payments: orchestration · routing & failover · PSP/acquirer/EMI/bank integrations · cards · payouts · loan repayments · wallets · Virtual IBANs · reconciliation · settlements · refunds & reversals · provider health management

Platform & integration: API contracts · transaction lifecycle & state models · async integrations · callbacks & webhooks · idempotency · retries · error mapping · monitoring & alerting

Compliance & monetization: PCI DSS (Service Provider) · KYC/AML · antifraud integrations · pricing model launches (CPA, subscriptions)

Ways of working: written specs & async decision-making · cross-functional work with Finance, Security & Compliance · AI agents and automation (Claude) · AI-assisted analysis and spec writing · SQL · Grafana · Amplitude · Mixpanel

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

Tomsk State University — Applied Mathematics and Cybernetics, 2014

Russian — Native · English — C1